AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Faculty of Business Studies

BUS208
Contemporary Issues in Marketing

Mid Term Assessment (MTA) – Form B

2025-2026 / Fall Semester

20-November-2025

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 2 hours

Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF**" mode throughout the examination.
This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
You **MUST** answer the questions using only the answer booklets provided
You **MUST** return the examination paper together with your answer booklets.
Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches
Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the examinati
Students are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

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Answer the following questions

Question One: (35 Marks) (Expected time: 30 min)

Omni-Channel Strategy at Starbucks

In the early 2010s, ***Starbucks*** faced increasing competition from both traditional coffee shops and emerging digital-first brands. Customers were demanding more convenience, personalization, and seamless experiences across physical and digital channels. Starbucks recognized the need to evolve from a brick-and-mortar coffee chain to an integrated omni-channel brand that could meet customers wherever they were, whether in-store, online, or on their mobile devices. Starbucks launched an ambitious omni-channel strategy to unify its physical and digital presence. The goal was to create a seamless, personalized experience for customers across all touchpoints.

A. **Define** Consumer omni-channel navigation behavior **(5 marks)**
B. *To execute an effective omni-channel strategy, companies must clarify the role of omni-channel marketing in their overall business models.* **Discuss** the potential *three* strategies that Starbucks could implement to execute an effective omni-channel approach. **(30 marks)**

Question Two: (35 Marks) (Expected time: 30 min)

As a marketing manager, you have been tasked with designing the sales force strategy and structure for a new product launch in a competitive market. This includes deciding on the size of the sales team, the type of salesforce structure and the recruitment and training strategy.

Based on this scenario, respond to the following questions:"

A. Explain the different types of salesforce structure **(20 marks)**
B. Discuss methods to decide on the size of sales team **(15 marks)**

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Question Three: (30 Marks) (Expected time: 30 min)

Define the following terms in the context of marketing. (6 marks each point)

1. Consumer promotions
2. Marketing research
3. Competitive marketing intelligence
4. Experimental research
5. Customer insights

End of exam

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